TELEVISION

SMALL MAGIC

Doordarshan had us glued to the tube in the late '80s with iconic shows and mythologicals. And then there was the great opening up to western pleasures in the '90s...

50TH ANNIVERSARY
1985-1995







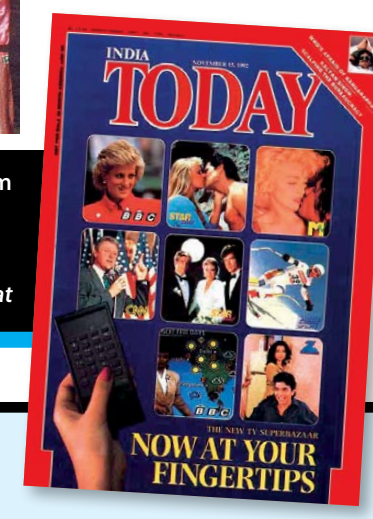








ON THE TUBE (Clockwise from top left) Stills from *Yeh Jo Hai Zindagi*, *Malgudi Days*, *Fauji*, MTV veejays, *Karamchand*, *Bharat Ek Khoj* and *Mahabharat*



Doordarshan was the lode star for Middle India in the late 1980s, a monopoly with a captive audience, bringing India together with mythologicals (*Ramayana*, *Mahabharat*) and iconic shows (*Buniyaad*, *Karamchand*, *Yeh Jo Hai Zindagi*, *Nukkad* and such). In 1991, along with the opening up of the economy, satellite broadcasting was opened to private players. CNN and Star Plus were early movers, and soon Indian channels like Zee TV, Sun TV, Asianet etc. were beaming into Indian homes. By the end of 1994, 70 million-plus homes in India (an estimated 400 million audience) had TVs and many of them had the luxury of choosing between some 100 channels. No surprises then that the 'remote' soon became a coveted piece of equipment at home. ■

NOW AT YOUR FINGERTIPS
Nov. 15, 1992

"The mundane television set has suddenly turned into an incredible technicolour dreamboat. The remote control has placed a glitzy new world at our fingertips. Enormous metallic objects... are beaming down a bewildering collage of images. And like a lost tribe discovering an oasis in the desert, lakhs of Indians are hot-wired into this superbazaar of soaps, sports, news, music, sex and much more"